



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is there a storm tonight?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you check the weather forecast? Every morning/evening?
- When was the last time the weather ruined your plans?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about extreme weather conditions.
- I can interrupt politely.
- I can ask for, record and pass on information.





Let's Explore!

Janet warns the team of an extreme weather warning. Does she have a **game plan***?

* A "game plan" is a plan for success in the future.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Alright everyone. As you are probably aware, there is an extreme weather warning for today. I just wanted to go over our game plan if we run into an emergency. Miranda, would you take notes please?
- Miranda:** Certainly.
- Peter:** Excuse me, but wouldn't it be wiser to just work from home?
- Janet:** Unfortunately we have several urgent meetings scheduled. According to the weather forecast, this severe storm will most likely not reach the city.
- Renata:** Sorry to interrupt, but can I ask something here? What kind of storm are we anticipating?
- Peter:** A cyclone. We haven't had a cyclone for decades. Extremely strong winds, possibly gusting up to 63 miles an hour. Torrential rains will accompany it, no doubt. Possibly a flash flood.
- Miranda:** Pardon me? Am I to write that down? What exactly was the forecast?
- Janet:** Extremely high winds. Please record that.
- Miranda:** Got it, thanks.
- Janet:** The secretary told me she will keep us posted via email and I will personally visit each office in the event of an emergency. Does anyone travel far?
- Renata:** Er, well, I live in Megville.
- Miranda:** Renata, I'm ten minutes away. Come over until the weather improves. Worst case scenario, you can always stay at my place!
- Renata:** Thanks Miranda. I hope I won't need to take you up on that.
- Miranda:** Renata at Miranda's in emergency - I've recorded that!
- Janet:** Alright everyone. Let's get to work and hope for the best!



Let's Practice!

Janet reads a bulletin. What's it about?

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Circle the correct option to complete the sentences. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

This is an important message from Environment Massachusetts. We are issuing an **bulletin / weather update / extreme weather warning**. We are preparing for the potential of **severe / high / colder** weather affecting our state. Meteorologists have forecasted that the **flash floods / cyclone / high wind** will cross the coast by Tuesday. We are anticipating extremely **flash floods / cyclone / high winds, severe / gusting / torrential** up to 63 miles per hour, **severe / gusting / torrential** rains and a possibility of **flash floods / cyclone / high wind**.



Let's Practice!

Are you keeping track of it all?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. via / secretary / us / . / me / told / posted / The / that / will / she / email / keep

2. the / the / say / will / reports / storm / weather / reach / The / that / city / not / .

3. we / kind / anticipating / of / are / storm / ? / What

4. winds / high / Extremely / .

5. What / ? / exactly / the / was / forecast

6. we / in / haven't / reported / that / had / ages / They / cyclone / a / .

7. an / emergency / the / . / that / stated / visit / in / of / She / she / each / will / event / office

8. in / . / Miranda's / at / Renata / emergency / of / case





Extension Activity

Let's talk about the weather.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go on the Internet and research a weather channel (e.g. The Weather Network).
- Choose the weather for your city.
- Make notes of the weather forecast for the next 2 or 3 days.
- Describe the weather to your partner.
- Interrupt when necessary to give your partner more details.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify and read weather forecasts for the next few days.

☐ ☐

I describe the weather to a partner.

☐ ☐

I interrupt politely when necessary.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **extreme weather warning** (noun): a statement telling someone that bad weather may happen in the future
e.g. There is an extreme weather warning for today.
- **gusting** (verb): increasing in amount and speed
e.g. There will be strong winds, possibly gusting up to 100 km an hour.
- **torrential** (adjective): falling in large amounts
e.g. Torrential rains are in the forecast.
- **flash flood** (noun): a sudden flood of water caused by heavy rain
e.g. There is a possibility of a flash flood.
- **cyclone** (noun): a violent tropical storm in which strong winds move in a circle
e.g. We haven't had a cyclone for decades.
- **high winds** (noun): moving air that is strong enough to cause damage
e.g. The forecast calls for extremely high winds.
- **severe** (adjective): harsh; unnecessarily extreme
e.g. The severe storm will not reach the city.





Learning Points

Asking for, Recording and Passing on Information

In the workplace, it is important to ask for, record and pass on information in meetings.

When you ask for information, you can use Wh- questions.

When recording information, you use short phrases. For example, *extremely high winds*.

When you pass on information, you report on what another person has said. You don't normally use the speaker's exact words (direct speech) but reported (indirect) speech. You use "reporting" verbs.

Asking for Information	Passing on Information
Who ... ? What ... ? When ... ? Where ... ? Why ... ?	Use verbs like: • say • tell • observe • state followed by the word "that"

Examples:

- *What does this weather forecast say?*
- *Torrential rains and high winds.*
- *They said that the storm would reach the city tomorrow.*





Learning Points

Interrupting Politely

In English, sometimes we need to interrupt people. This can be because we need to say something, express our opinion, or make a suggestion.

Interruptions are acceptable and perfectly normal, but too many interruptions can seem rude. Here are some common ways we can use to interrupt:

Interrupting Politely

- Sorry to interrupt ...
- Excuse me, but ...
- Pardon me, ...
- Er, well ...
- Can I add/ask something here?

Examples:

- ***Sorry to interrupt, but*** *I missed that last part.*
- ***Er, well,*** *I live a bit far from here.*

The verb "interrupt" follows the pattern "interrupt someone". We do not use any prepositions after this verb.

Example:

- *She tried to explain the problem, but he **interrupted her** mid-sentence.*

